

MONGOL ARMOUR AND WEAPONS

The **Mongol warriors** who swept through Central Asia, Eastern Europe, and China in the 13th century came from a nomadic tradition that valued mobility and the ability to strike from a distance. Mongol discipline was fierce – the army punished unlicensed plundering with death. They were organized into *tümens* (units of 10,000 men) centred around an imperial guard. Fighting from horseback, the Mongols were armed with composite bows that had a range of up to 200m (655ft), and a mixture of light arrows for greater range and heavier ones for penetrative power. Once an enemy had been softened up by multiple volleys of arrows, heavier cavalry armed with sabres moved in to finish off the survivors.

► MONGOL HELMET

Date 13th century

Origin Mongolia

Material Iron, leather, fur

The warrior's helmet had a traditional conical shape, trimmed with a padded roll of fur for a snug fit and protection against extreme cold.

Peak recalled traditional shape of nomad felt cap



Short, articulated sleeves allowed full range of arm movement

Helmet bowl of iron plates



▲ MONGOL BOOTS

Date 18th century

Origin Mongolia

Material Leather, felt

A Mongol warrior generally wore felt boots in both summer and winter. The boots provided protection from the bitter cold of the steppes and prevented their legs from rubbing against the horse's back and chafing.

► MONGOL ARMOUR

Date 13th century

Origin Mongolia

Material Leather, iron

Lamellar, or scale armour, was made from overlapping leather or metal strips. Arrows that penetrated the armour would get caught in the silk layer beneath, making it easier to extract them.

Overlapping leather armour plates

